The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: October 2026 to date. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

October 2026 Incomplete October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Services

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Gross margin = revenue less contractors and consultant time charged to the work at $60 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: consultant time not charged to clients, and overheads (management and admin wages, marketing, rent, IT, insurance, travel, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit · latest closed month: September

October is still in progress and wages are paid fortnightly, so a part month can't be bridged: this is September, the latest closed month. September's client work made $81,890 gross margin (56.3%). Consultant time not charged to client work took $14,352 and overheads $52,140, leaving $15,398 profit before tax (10.6% of revenue). To cover overheads, client work needs a 45.8% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on client work	$81,890
Consultant wages and on-costs	$60,192
Consultant time charged to client work (at cost)	$45,840
Consultant time not charged to client work	$14,352
Gross profit (the P&L)	$67,538
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$52,140
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$15,398
Revenue	$145,330
Gross margin on client work, %	56.3%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	10.6%
Gross margin client work need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**45.8%**

Type of work: All

October so far against October last year **(37.5%)**
$49,055 against $78,550

Year to date against the same period last year
48.1%
$454,340 against $306,750

Gross margin, year to date
64.0%
$290,660 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is 48.1% up on the same period last year, year to date ($454,340 against $306,750). Retainers make the highest gross margin (71.3%); Projects the lowest (60.5%). The business needs 45.8% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Projects: 60.5% gross margin, 20.5 points over the 40.0% target ($57,324 ahead on $280,040 this financial year to date). Retainers: 71.3% gross margin, 31.3 points over the 40.0% target ($44,700 ahead on $142,800 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Projects

October so far against October last year
(73.6%)
$13,355 against $50,650

Year to date against the same period last year
35.4%
$280,040 against $206,750

Gross margin, year to date
60.5%
$169,340 before overheads

What it shows

Projects brought in $280,040 this financial year to date, 35.4% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 48.1%), at a 60.5% gross margin (below the 64.0% overall).

What you'd do about it

Projects: 60.5% gross margin, 20.5 points over the 40.0% target ($57,324 ahead on $280,040 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Retainers

October so far against October last year
99.4%
$35,700 against $17,900

Year to date against the same period last year
99.4%
$142,800 against $71,600

Gross margin, year to date
71.3%
$101,820 before overheads

What it shows

Retainers brought in $142,800 this financial year to date, 99.4% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 48.1%), at a 71.3% gross margin (above the 64.0% overall).

What you'd do about it

Retainers: 71.3% gross margin, 31.3 points over the 40.0% target ($44,700 ahead on $142,800 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Training

October so far against October last year
(100.0%)
$0 against $10,000

Year to date against the same period last year
10.9%
$31,500 against $28,400

Gross margin, year to date
61.9%
$19,500 before overheads

What it shows

Training brought in $31,500 this financial year to date, 10.9% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 48.1%), at a 61.9% gross margin (below the 64.0% overall).

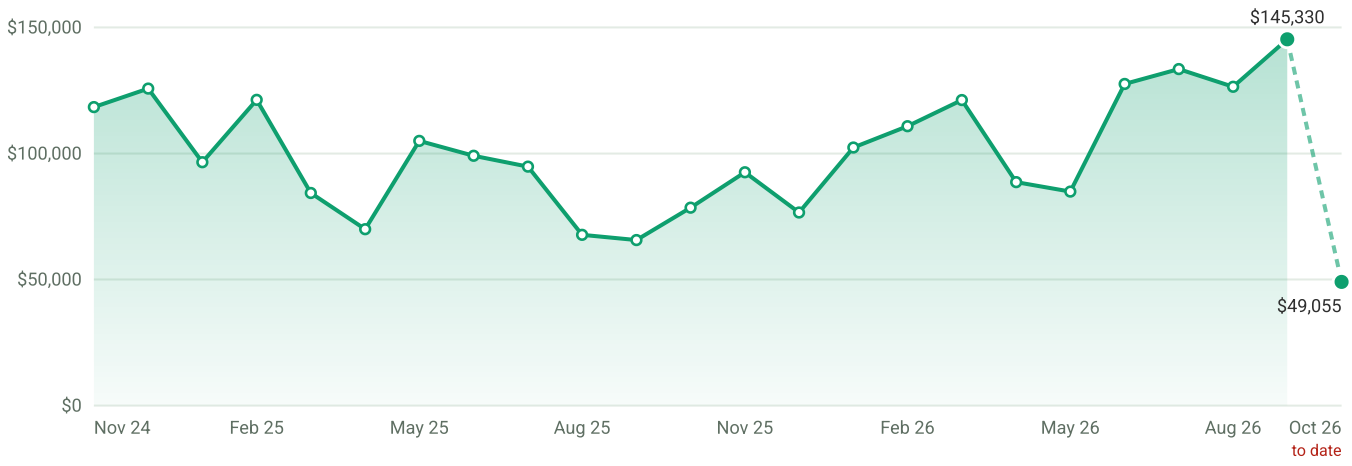
What you'd do about it

Training: 61.9% gross margin, 21.9 points over the 40.0% target ($6,900 ahead on $31,500 this financial year to date).

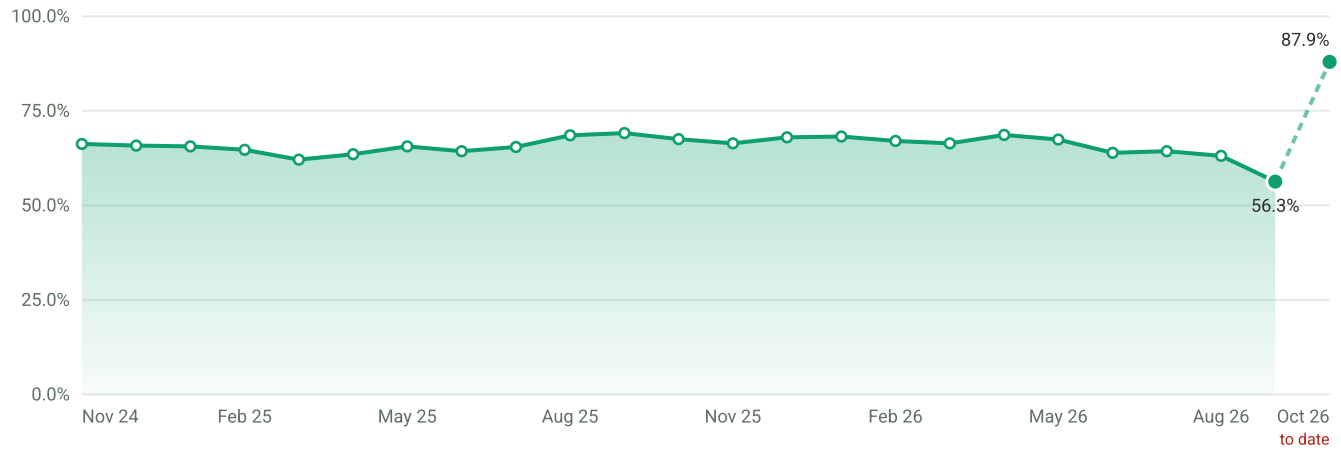
Every type of work at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by type of work, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By type of work: financial year to date (Jul to Oct 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Projects	$280,040	$206,750	35.4%	$169,340	60.5%
Retainers	$142,800	$71,600	99.4%	$101,820	71.3%
Training	$31,500	$28,400	10.9%	$19,500	61.9%
Total	$454,340	$306,750	48.1%	$290,660	64.0%

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.